to Netanyahu, “then, go home.” They argue that it was promised to them in the coalition agreements. Will they be ready to leave the coalition?

As I said before, I have known very liberal and gentle religious people, but they were not typical of the Orthodox community. This is a community closed in upon itself, focused upon its own interests and very little else. As long as it was but a relatively weak group among much stronger parties, it adapted to the will of the majority, but now that it is a strong component of the coalition, it will insist on getting all that has been promised to it.

The self-imposed isolation of Orthodox Jewry is an attitude steeped in age-long tradition. Before the second half of the eighteenth century, the immense majority of Jews followed various strands of Orthodoxy and lived in isolation from surrounding non-Jewish society, out of duress and, partly, out of choice. During the Shoah, Orthodox rabbis tried to save themselves at whatever cost and, after the war, they accused the secular parties of all possible wrongdoing. Even the commemoration of the Shoah in Israel was exclusive for a long time, as far as the Orthodox were concerned. To this day, as I have mentioned several times, the Orthodox parties recognize the state only as long as it can fulfill their own interests.

It would be a mistake to identify the Orthodox with the Mizrahim. A segment, the followers of Shas, are so by definition. But in fact, in the Lithuanian *yeshivot*, as in the Hasidic ones, there is an unspoken *numerus clausus* against Mizrahi candidates, one of the reasons for the foundation of Shas. In a sense, the would-be Purim film of the twelfth-grade girls belonging to the religious school Horev in Jerusalem, which created such a scandal, may not be far from the general atmosphere.

Among the religious friends that we had in Jerusalem and who were profoundly liberal were the professor of Jewish philosophy Stéphane Mosès and his wife, the painter Liliane Klapisch. But this wasn’t the common attitude among the Orthodox immigrants from France after the Six-Day War. This “Alsatian” immigration was both Ashkenazi and Orthodox. Over